MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | DevOps & Infrastructure

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Infrastructure-focused QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including recent hands-on work in CI/CD pipelines, Kubernetes-based test environments, and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines supporting three product teams and has improved pipeline speed, reliability, and test-environment automation. Practical experience with Terraform, GitOps, monitoring, and TLS in personal infrastructure projects.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes, k3s, Terraform, Argo CD, Ansible (basic)
Observability and networking: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik, cert-manager, TLS
Programming and data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Linux, Git

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments using Docker Compose and later Helm on the shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enable QA and product teams to review features before merge, with end-to-end tests running against the environments.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built Python tooling and Grafana dashboards using CI test results stored in PostgreSQL to identify flaky tests by team.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs for nightly regression runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented per-merge-request environments deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI, including an application, PostgreSQL and seeded data.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity, and enabled feature reviews and end-to-end testing before merge.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Helm, Kubernetes, Docker, Bash, PostgreSQL.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Technologies: GitLab CI, Docker, pytest-xdist.

EDUCATION

BEng, Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology *2018*

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)